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🌐 School Profile

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EDUCATION

•University of Utah

research interest: Corporate Finance, Intangible Assets, Digital Platform, Consumer Finance

2022 Aug - Current

Ph.D., Finance

•Seoul National University

2019 - 2021

M.S., Finance

•University of Seoul

2013 - 2019

B.A., Business Administration

WORKING PAPERS

•Commoditize Your Complement: Strategic Open-Source Releases and the Cannibalization of Rival Firms

Won, P. Y. (2026). Available at SSRN.

- Why do firms release open-source software for free? This paper investigates how dominant technology firms strategically release free open-source software (OSS) to commoditize complementary markets and devalue competitors' proprietary assets. Exploiting the staggered release of major GitHub repositories, I find that this strategy triggers a wealth transfer: focal firms experience a 13.9% increase in market valuation, capturing over \$406 billion in aggregate wealth, while exposed rivals suffer a 7.6% decline. This strategy forces competitors into technological dependence, compelling them to shift human capital toward the focal firm's OSS. Consequently, while rivals experience a decline in sales, their forced adaptation yields cost efficiencies that inflate short-term profit margins. However, this defensive restructuring ultimately impairs their long-term innovation and product market dynamics: direct rivals decrease R&D expenditures by 14.8%, curtail exploratory innovation, and exhibit reduced product market fluidity. Ultimately, free OSS structurally reorganizes industry competition.

– [\[Click Here for paper link\]](#)

•(Digital) Platform Data Power

Won, P. Y. (2026). Available at SSRN.

- Presented at: 2nd HKU Next-Gen Finance PhD Workshop (2026)
- How do digital platforms exploit their dual role as marketplace operators to strategically compete with third-party sellers? To answer this, I introduce the Data Power Index (DPI), a novel measure quantifying Amazon's accumulated informational advantage. Unlike traditional market power measures such as the HHI, the DPI reveals that tighter data environments compress seller margins and force exposed public firms to cut costs and accelerate innovation. Crucially, this informational advantage robustly predicts the timing and targets of Amazon's private-label entry. After Amazon's entry, incumbent sellers suffer sharp declines in profitability, while exposed firms face heightened risk. Ultimately, this data-driven encroachment creates an important welfare trade-off: aggregate consumer surplus expands, but it is systematically reallocated away from incumbent sellers.

– [\[Click Here for paper link\]](#)

•Short-Term Lending and Usury Limits: Consumer Impact and Market Adaptation

Jansen, M., Zack, L., Voges, R., & Won, P. Y. (2026) Available at SSRN.

- Presented at: Financial Intermediation Research Society (FIRS) Conference (2025), International Banking, Economics, and Finance Association (IBEFA) 99th Annual WEAI Conference (2025), Wasatch Finance Conference (2024)
- Alternative financial services (AFS), such as payday lending, provide valuable credit access to underserved consumers, but their impact on consumer welfare has sparked debate. Using borrower-level data from more than 2.8 million auto loan applicants, we investigate the effects of usury laws on AFS usage and spillover effects on traditional credit markets. We find that interest rate caps significantly reduce AFS usage, particularly for low-credit borrowers, and that many consumers switch between AFS modes (such as from storefront to online lenders) when the credit supply is restricted. These restrictions are correlated with declines in credit scores, which limit consumers' access to traditional credit markets. The findings suggest that more targeted regulations could address underserved consumers' diverse needs and behaviors better than one-size-fits-all legislative approaches.

– [\[Click Here for paper link\]](#)

•Does 0DTE Options Trading Increase Volatility?

Brogaard, J., Han, J., & Won, P. Y. (2026). Available at SSRN.

- Presented at: 13th Annual Conference on Financial Market Regulation (CFMR 2026)

- Media Coverage: *Bloomberg “Zero-Day Options Are Reordering the Way the Stock Market Behaves”, 2023*
- This paper examines the impact of Zero-Day-to-Expiration (0DTE) options trading on stock market volatility. The monthly trading volume of 0DTE options linked to indices increased from .08 million contracts in January 2011 to 34.4 million contracts in August 2023 and now accounts for 48% of the trading in index options. Using the staggered introduction of index weekly options as an instrument variable, we show that a one standard deviation increase in 0DTE options trading leads to 9.10% increase relative to the mean value of volatility, which is 15.91% of its standard deviation. Even after controlling for option market makers’ gamma hedging, we find that the overall impact on volatility remains positive and is primarily driven by speculative retail investors.
- [\[Click Here for paper link\]](#)

PUBLISHED PAPERS

- **Cyclical consumption and expected stock returns: Evidence from the Korean capital market.** 2021
Won, Y. W., Won, C., & Won, Y. (2021). Global Business & Finance Review (GBFR), 26(3), 14-32.

- In this study, we empirically demonstrate how the new variable of ‘cyclical consumption’ can capture consumption risk and predict expected stock returns, which relationship is stronger and should be considered as the primary macro indicator for stock markets between KOSPI and KOSDAQ, and which specific industries exhibit stronger or weaker relationship with cyclical consumption in the Korean capital market.
- [\[Click Here for paper link\]](#)

- **Determinants of the Prices and Returns of Preferred Stocks** 2020
Kim, S., Won, C. H., & Won, Y. W. (2020). Asia-Pacific Journal of Business, 11(2), 159-172.

- The purpose of this study is to investigate economic variables which have impact on the prices and returns of preferred stocks and to provide investors, underwriters, and policy makers with information regarding correlations and causal relations between them. Empirical results show that the significant variables influencing the prices and returns of preferred stocks are consumer sentiment index, consumer price index, industrial production index, KOSPI volatility index, and exchange rate between Korean won and US dollar.
- [\[Click Here for paper link\]](#)

TECHNICAL SKILLS AND INTERESTS

Languages: Both fluent at English and Korean (Dual Citizenship)

Developer Tools: SAS, STATA, R, Python, Matlab

Areas of Interest: empirical asset pricing, consumer finance, and empirical corporate finance

SCHOLARSHIPS & GRANTS, AND AWARDS

- 2024 Dewey Research Data Grant (\$7,200) 2024
- University of Utah, MSE Rising Scholar Award 2022
- Seoul National University, Business School TA/RA Scholarship 2019-2021
- University of Seoul, Summa Cum Laude by Seoul Mayor 2018
- University of Seoul, Honors Scholarship for the Dean’s List 2017

ACHIEVEMENTS

- MEN (Maeil Economy Newspaper) economics thesis contest, 3rd 2021
- Best KATUSA Warrior Friendship Week of 2017 Year 2017
- The 46th Six Salute representative for ROK Army 2017
- Monthly Best KATUSA champion on designated battalion 2016
- General Paik, Sun Yup Leadership Award champion 2016